

vSFG-7 · AI ATC ON SRS

SKYEYE ATC

HORNET · VIPER

Command · Deckboss · Marshal · Paddles · JTAC · Texaco · GCI · Towers

Persian Gulf · Syria · Black Sea

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SKYEYE ATC

AI controllers on SRS · Command, Deckboss, Marshal, towers · Persian Gulf · Syria · Black Sea

WHAT IT IS

read this first

- **An AI controller that talks to you over SRS.** It hears you with speech recognition, answers in a generated voice, and sees where you are through Tacview - so when you say "10 DME" it can check.
- **It listens for key words, not exact sentences.** Speak normally, but use the words on these cards - they are the triggers the code actually matches.

THE ROLES

same calls in every theatre

COMMAND - squadron net	**282.000 AM**
DECKBOSS - carrier deck	**128.600 AM**
MARSHAL - carrier stack	**306.300 AM · every theatre**
PADDLES - LSO, Black Sea + Syria	**128.300 AM · card 10**
HITMAN 1-1 / 2-1 - JTAC, Black Sea	**61.0 / 62.0 FM · cards 13 - 14**
RANGE AREAS + OVERLORD - on Command	**cards 15 - 16**
TEXACO 1-1 / 2-1 / 3-1 - Hornet tankers	**252.1 / .2 / .3 AM · card 17**
SHELL 1-1 / 2-1 - Viper boom tankers	**253.1 / 253.2 AM · card 18**
DARKSTAR / OVERLORD - GCI	**264.0 / 266.0 AM · cards 19 - 20**
COMBAT CALLS - shots, CSAR, damaged jet	**AWACS or Command · card 21**
TOWERS - one per airfield	**cards 23 - 29**

HOW TO BE HEARD

every call

- **Lead with the role name, then your callsign.** "Marshal, Raider 1, ..." - for a tower, the field name. Marshal ignores any call that does not start with its name; Deckboss ignores most of them.
- **Say your full callsign every time.** "Raider 1", not "1".
- **Pause half a second after you key the mic,** then speak. Calls shorter than about 0.2 s are thrown away.
- **Wait 2 - 3 seconds for the answer.** Recognition, the reply and the voice take that long. Do not re-key over it.
- **Radios AM (Hitman FM), encryption off.** Keep each call short - two short calls beat one long one.

ATIS is listen-only. Paddles answers your ball call; the rest is his calls.

FREQUENCIES

Where SkyEye actually listens · per theatre · Hornet preset shown for each; Vipers use Command only.

PERSIAN GULF — Hornet preset

COMMAND 282.000	COMM 1 CH 4 · Viper COMM 1 CH 1
DECKBOSS 128.600	COMM 1 CH 1
MARSHAL 306.300	COMM 1 CH 3

SYRIA — Hornet preset

COMMAND 282.000	COMM 1 CH 4 · Viper COMM 1 CH 1
DECKBOSS 128.600	COMM 1 CH 1
MARSHAL 306.300	COMM 1 CH 3
OVERLORD 266.000 - GCI	dial it

BLACK SEA — Hornet preset

COMMAND 282.000	COMM 1 CH 4 · Viper COMM 1 CH 1
DECKBOSS 128.600	COMM 1 CH 1
MARSHAL 306.300	COMM 1 CH 3
DARKSTAR 264.000 - GCI	COMM 1 CH 5

READING THE PRESET CARDS — read this

- **"AI" on a carrier preset means SkyEye.** COMM 1 CH 3 "CVN-72 AI MARSHALL" 306.300 is SkyEye Marshal in every theatre (operator ruling 2026-09-20).
- **COMM 1 CH 2 "CVN-72 MARSHAL" 306.200 is for a live human Marshal.** SkyEye never answers there.
- **Deckboss 128.600 is shared** with the DCS AI carrier controller - you may hear both.
- **SkyEye Paddles is 128.300 - dial it.** Black Sea and Syria. LSO 128.100 on the cards is for a human LSO.

Voices: towers British or Australian · Command, Marshal, Deckboss American · Hitman 1-1 Australian.

DECKBOSS

Carrier deck · 128.600 AM · Hornet COMM 1 CH 1 · Cat assignment, conga line, launch.

THE LAUNCH — in order

REQUEST TAXI	"Deckboss, Raider 1, request taxi" - or green jet.
	Reply: cleared to cat N, or join the conga line.
TENSION	"Deckboss, Raider 1, ready cat 2" - or shoot.
	Reply: under tension, spin it up, shooter's discretion.
T + 10 s	Your cat is freed; the next jet hears cat N is clear.
AIRBORNE	"Raider 1, airborne" - no address needed.
	Reply: copy airborne, push Marshal and its frequency.

THE RULES

- **Deckboss does not call the shot.** Nobody says shoot on the radio - the shooter fires you. Run up when you hear "spin it up".
- **Four cats: 1 and 2 on the bow, 3 and 4 on the waist.** If all four are taken you join the conga line; it holds six. After that you hear "deck is full, hold clear".
- **Checking in twice does not take a second cat.** If you are already in the line you are told your number.

DECKBOSS CALLS

Every call it answers · lead with "Deckboss," · The airborne call is the only one that works without it.

YOU SAY	Deckboss replies
request taxi / ready for taxi / green jet	cat N or conga
ready cat N / tension cat N / shoot	under tension
airborne / clear traffic	push Marshal
remain in bolter	contact LSO
say BRC / request BRC	mother's BRC, magnetic
radio check / comm check / how copy	loud and clear
pushing Marshal / pushing command	short ack

SAMPLE — Raider 1 and Raider 2 on the deck

RAIDER 1	Deckboss, Raider 1, request taxi.
DECKBOSS	Raider 1, Deckboss, cleared to cat two.
RAIDER 1	Deckboss, Raider 1, ready cat two.
DECKBOSS	Raider 1, Deckboss, under tension cat two,
	spin it up, shooter's discretion.
DECKBOSS	Raider 2, Deckboss, cat two is clear.
RAIDER 1	Raider 1, airborne.
DECKBOSS	Raider 1, Deckboss, copy airborne,
	push Marshal, three zero six point three.

Bolter practice: Deckboss hands you to the LSO - Paddles 128.300 in the Black Sea and Syria.

MARSHAL CASE I

Carrier stack · 306.300 · every theatre · Lead every call with "Marshal," - or it is ignored.

THE RECOVERY

Case I and Case II use these calls

MARKING MOMS	Marshal, Raider 1, marking moms, 30 DME,
	angels 12, state 6.5.
	Reply: radar contact, weather, case, BRC,
	altimeter, Marshal at angels N,
	report see me at ten.
DME REPORTS	Marshal, Raider 1, 20 DME - optional, acked.
SEE YOU AT 10	Reply: visual at ten, say state.
STATE	Marshal, Raider 1, state 5.2 - under 2.0 is priority.
ESTABLISHED	Marshal, Raider 1, established angels 3
	Reply: signal Charlie - or your stack position, hold.
COMMENCING	Reply: call three mile initial.
INITIAL	At 3 nm. Reply: contact paddles, good luck.

THE STACK

- **"Marshal at angels N" is your stack altitude.** The lowest free altitude from angels 2 to angels 9. Marshal counts aircraft already in the stack and any contact within 50 nm at that altitude.
- **When someone commences, the stack steps down silently.** There is no radio call for it - keep flying your assigned angels.
- **After initial, switch to Paddles.** Black Sea and Syria: SkyEye Paddles on 128.300, card 10. Gulf: fly the ball and trap.

ANY TIME

- **"Marshal, Raider 1, say BRC"** - mother's BRC, magnetic. "request BRC" and a bare "BRC" work too.
- **"Marshal, Raider 1, checking in"** - your range and bearing from mother, then marking moms please.

Word-for-word calls and replies: cards 7 - 9.

MARSHAL CASE III

Night or low weather · same trigger words, new answers · Marshal picks the case itself from time and weather.

WHICH CASE — decided by SkyEye

Night (local 1800 - 0600)	CASE III
Ceiling under 1,500 ft or vis under 3 nm	CASE III
Ceiling under 3,000 ft or vis under 5 nm	CASE II
Otherwise	CASE I

- **If the case changes while you are inbound,** you hear: "All marshal aircraft, recovery is now Case Three, acknowledge on next push."

CASE III CALLS — what changes

MARKING MOMS	Reply: marshal on the NNN, DD DME, angels N, expected approach time is MM, report established.
ESTABLISHED	Reply: approach time MM. There is no Charlie.
COMMENCING	At your MM. Reply: radar contact, descend to platform 5,000, final bearing NNN, confirm BRC NNN, report platform.
PLATFORM	Passing 5,000 ft. Reply: final bearing NNN.
8 MILES	Marshal: eight miles, dirty up. No reply.
3 MILES	Marshal: contact paddles, call the ball. Switch and make the ball call at three-quarters. No initial call.
BOLTER	Marshal: climb to 1,200, at 4 miles turn downwind, report abeam. Abeam: turn final, Paddles again at 3 miles.

- **Marshal radial = final bearing + 180. Final bearing = BRC - 9.** All magnetic. The stack starts at angels 6; the DME is angels + 15 (angels 6 at 21 DME).
- **MM is minutes past the hour.** The first aircraft commences 10 minutes out; each one after is 10 minutes later. Miss your time and Marshal gives you a new one.

MARSHAL CALLS 1

Word for word · check-in, marking moms, BRC, radar · Example: BRC 275, alt 29.92, angels 12, 30 nm on the 340.

CHECKING IN — optional first call

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, checking in.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12,
	30 miles from mother, bearing three four zero,
	say marking mom's and state.
NO RADAR	Raider 1, Union Marshal, go ahead with
	marking mom's and state.

MARKING MOMS — Case I and Case II

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, marking moms 340 for 30,
	angels 12, state 6.5.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12,
	range 30 miles, bearing three four zero from mother,
	mother's weather ceiling unrestricted,
	visibility ten plus, expect Case One recovery,
	BRC 275, altimeter two niner niner two,
	Marshal at angels two, report see me at ten.
2+ IN STACK	The reply ends: Stack has 2 aircraft.
NO RADAR	The radar contact part is left out.

BRC — any time

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, say BRC.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, mother's BRC is 275.
NO CARRIER	Raider 1, Union Marshal, BRC unknown, mother off scope.

RADAR CHECK AND RADIO CHECK

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, radar check.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12,
	range 30 miles, bearing three four zero from mother.
NO RADAR	Raider 1, Union Marshal, negative radar contact,
	say posit relative mother.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, radio check.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, loud and clear.

Marshal picks one of 2 - 4 wordings at random - the first is shown. Same facts, same order of calls.

MARSHAL CALLS 2

Word for word · inbound to the trap, and the departure · Case I and Case II. Example as card 7.

INBOUND — in order

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, 20 DME.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, radar contact, 20 DME, continue.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, see you at ten.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, visual carrier at ten miles,
	say state.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, state 5.2.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, copy state 5.2.
UNDER 2.0	Raider 1, Union Marshal, state 1.8, expedite recovery.

THE STACK — to the trap

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, established angels two.
DECK CLEAR	Raider 1, Union Marshal, signal Charlie.
DECK BUSY	Raider 1, Union Marshal, entering stack at angels two,
	position one, hold for Charlie.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, commencing, state 4.0.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, copy commencing, state 4.0,
	check in three mile initial.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, initial.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, contact paddles, good luck.

OFF THE BOAT — after Deckboss pushes you

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, clear seven miles.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, clear of Union control zone,
	push vSFG-7-Command, two eight two point zero,
	channel four, for tasking.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, pushing command.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, cleared handoff to
	vSFG-7-Command, good day.

Marshal picks one of 2 - 4 wordings at random - the first is shown. Same facts, same order of calls.

MARSHAL CALLS 3

Word for word · Case III (night or low weather) · Example: BRC 275, ceiling 800, vis 2, approach time 15.

MARKING MOMS — Case III

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, marking moms 340 for 30,
	angels 12, state 6.5.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, radar contact, angels 12,
	range 30 miles from the Abe, bearing three four zero,
	mother's weather ceiling eight hundred overcast,
	visibility 2, Case Three recovery, BRC 275,
	altimeter two niner niner two,
	marshal on the zero eight six, two one DME, angels six,
	expected approach time is one five, report established.

HOLD TO PLATFORM — in order

YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, established angels six.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, roger established angels six,
	marshal on the zero eight six, two one DME,
	expected approach time is one five.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, commencing.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, copy commencing, radar contact,
	descend to platform five thousand, final bearing
	two six six, confirm BRC two seven five, report platform.
YOU	Marshal, Raider 1, platform.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, copy platform,
	final bearing two six six.
8 MILES	Raider 1, Union Marshal, eight miles, dirty up.
3 MILES	Raider 1, Union Marshal, three miles,
	contact paddles, call the ball.

BOLTER / WAVE-OFF — Marshal sees it, or you call it

YOU	Raider 1, bolter. (or: Raider 1, wave off.)
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, roger bolter, climb to one
	thousand two hundred, at four miles turn downwind,
	report abeam.
YOU	Raider 1, abeam.
MARSHAL	Raider 1, Union Marshal, roger abeam, four miles past
	abeam turn final, final bearing two six six.

CASE CHANGE — to everyone in the stack

MARSHAL	All marshal aircraft, Union Marshal, recovery is now
	Case Three, acknowledge on next push.

- **Radial 086 = final bearing 266 + 180. Final bearing = BRC 275 - 9.** "Approach time one five" is 15 minutes past the hour; the next jet's is ten minutes later.

Marshal picks one of 2 - 4 wordings at random - the first is shown. Same facts, same order of calls.

PADDLES

SkyEye LSO · 128.300 AM · Black Sea + Syria · dial it · You call the ball; he talks you down. No readbacks.

ABEAM AND THE BALL CALL

after Marshal's "contact paddles"

ABEAM	302 abeam.
PADDLES	Paddles contact, 302, Hornet in the groove,
	at three-quarters of a mile call the ball.
YOU	302, Hornet ball, 5.5.
PADDLES	Roger ball.
CLARA	302, Clara, 5.0. -> Paddles contact, keep it coming.
NO CALL	By 0.6 nm: Call the ball.
RADIO CHECK	Paddles, Raider 302, radio check. -> loud and clear.

IN THE GROOVE

he calls, you fly

a little high / high	**A little high. / You're high.**
still high after 3 s	**You're high, bring it down.**
low, far out / in close	**You're low, power. / Power!**
still low / low and sinking	**POWER! / Power, power, POWER!**
over-correcting after power	**Easy with it.**
left / right of the line	**Right for lineup. / Come left.**
Hornet AoA off by 2	**You're fast. / You're slow.**

WAVE OFF AND BOLTER

low or off line in close	**Wave off, wave off, wave off.**
deck foul at 1/4 nm	**302, foul deck, wave off, wave off, proceed to bolter pattern.**
past the wires	**Bolter, bolter, bolter.**
trap	**nothing - the grade goes in the log**

After your trap, on 128.3: "red deck", then "green deck" once clear - Paddles sends you to Deckboss.

Say the modex first - with two in the groove it is how he knows whose ball.

OFF THE BOAT

Launch to Command · Deckboss -> Marshal -> Command · Three legs, three frequencies.

THE CHAIN — in order

1 DECKBOSS	Raider 1, airborne.
	Reply: copy airborne, push Marshal and its frequency.
2 MARSHAL	Marshal, Raider 1, clear seven miles.
	Reply: clear of Union control zone,
	push vSFG-7-Command,
	two eight two point zero, channel four, for tasking.
3 COMMAND	Command, Raider 1, checking in.
4 DARKSTAR	Black Sea: Darkstar 264.0 for picture - card 19.

GET THE CLEAR CALL RIGHT

- **Say "clear" and a distance:** "clear seven miles", "clear seven DME", "clear of mother" or "clear mothers".
- **Do not add recovery words to it.** If the call also has marking moms, state, initial, established, commencing, platform or bolter in it, Marshal treats you as inbound.
- **"Channel four" is the Hornet's Command preset.** Vipers never launch from the boat - their Command is COMM 1 CH 1.
- **Deckboss names the right Marshal for the theatre:** 306.300 in every theatre.

COMMAND

282.000 AM · Hornet COMM 1 CH 4 · Viper COMM 1 CH 1 · The squadron net. Both jets, every theatre.

YOU SAY — Command replies

radio check / comm check / how copy	**loud and clear**
checking in / check in	**proceed mission**
fence in / fence check	**cleared hot · where the GCI is**
in hot / pickle / Fox 3 / splash	**cleared hot · copy**
302 ejecting / I'm hit / mayday	**CSAR · nearest field - card 21**
on station	**good hunting**
off station / departing station	**proceed to assigned pattern**
fence out	**safe passage**
RTB / request recovery / bingo home plate	**expect handoff at 30 nm**
state 5.2	**copy state**
say bullseye / request bullseye	**bullseye NNN for NN**
request tanker / say texaco	**bearing, range, angels · Black Sea: cards 17 - 18**
request tasking (Black Sea training)	**contact Hitman 1-1 or 2-1 - card 13**
proceeding to / request Alpha (Black Sea)	**range areas - cards 15 - 16**

- **"RTB, fence out" is read as RTB.** The recovery words are checked before fence out.
- **Add your state to any call.** "fence out, state 1.8" - under 2.0 Command tells you you are bingo.

BULLSEYE AND TANKER — from the radar picture

- **Bearings are magnetic.** Bullseye is your own side's. The tanker is the nearest friendly one - by type, or a Texaco, Arco or Shell callsign.
- **No picture, no answer:** you hear "unable" or "negative tanker on scope".

THE AUTOMATIC HANDOFF — you do not ask for it

- **Once you have talked to Command, it watches you on Tacview** - when the rig has Tacview connected. Inside 30 nm of your nearest recovery - a field or the carrier - it calls you once.
- **Field:** "contact <field> tower on <frequency>, switching now approved, good landing."
- **Carrier:** "contact Marshal on <frequency>, switching now approved, call marking mom."
- **Launched from the boat?** You are sent to Marshal inside 30 nm of it, even when a field is nearer.

HITMAN 1-1 / 2-1

1-1 61.000 FM · Hornet COMM 2 CH 12 · Viper COMM 2 CH 8 · 2-1 62.000 FM · no preset yet - dial it

THE RUN

every call starts "Hitman, Raider 1, ..."

COMMAND	request tasking -> contact Hitman 1-1 or 2-1
CHECK IN	checking in -> Hitman picks the target, 9-line
COPY	copy -> report IP inbound
IP INBOUND	IP inbound -> continue
IN	in from the <dir> -> cleared hot, or abort
OFF	off -> egress per line 9

THE 9-LINE

by reference to your kneeboard card

- **Two JTACs, one sector each.** Hitman 1-1 runs Kuban Valley (1 - 3), Hitman 2-1 Cherkessk (4 - 5). Command sends you to the one with a free target - the other sector when you come back for more.
- **Hitman picks the target, at random.** Not one another flight is working, not the one you just did. Hitman reads its number, name and IP, and the IP's bearing if you are not there yet - elevation, attack headings and egress are on that kneeboard card.
- **Another target:** after "off", say "request tasking" to Hitman - or ask Command again.

JTAC LIVE 60.000 (Hornet COMM 2 CH 15) is for a human JTAC. Hitman never answers there.

CLEARED HOT?

What Hitman checks · from Tacview, against your 9-line card · Bearings and headings magnetic.

HITMAN CHECKS — or tells you why not

IP inbound	**within 20 nm of the IP**
not there	**negative - IP bears NNN for NN**
off the run-in line	**continue, run in heading NNN**
nose off the target	**continue, check heading**
In call	**inside the final attack heading**
and	**0.5 - 15 nm from the target**
outside either	**abort, abort, abort - and why**

AFTER CLEARED HOT — Hitman keeps watching

- **Swing more than 10 deg outside the final attack heading** while still pointed at the target, before a weapon comes off, and Hitman calls the abort. Go round from the IP.
- **Pulling off, a release, or 1.5 nm to go** ends the watch.
- **No radar picture of you** (Tacview down, callsign not matched): no checks - still cleared hot.

BDA — about 15 s after your bombs land

good effects / good hits / shack	**egress, ready for more tasking**
partial effects	**kills so far, re-attack approved**
no effects	**correct <dir> <metres>, re-attack**
unable to assess (the bridges)	**say your observed effects**

- **Asked for your effects?** "bridge dropped" or "good hits" closes it; "no effects" gets a re-attack. "request BDA" repeats the call.

ALSO — any time

abort	**copy abort, re-attack from the IP**
radio check	**loud and clear**

RANGE AREAS

Command · 282.000 AM · Black Sea training · Letters match the kneeboard TARGET RANGES card.

WHAT COMMAND TELLS YOU	threat
A Maykop airfield · SA-6, parked aircraft	SA-6
B Krasnodar Pashkovsky · SA-6, aircraft	SA-6
C 22 nm NE Maykop · SA-6, armour, infantry	SA-6
D 9-line targets 1 + 2	Hitman 1-1
E 191 nm NW Anapa · SA-10 site	SA-10
F 14 nm SW Krasnodar · armour, infantry	none
G 9 nm N Krymsk · SA-2 site	SA-2
H / I 9-line targets 4 / 5	Hitman 2-1
J 9 nm SW Krymsk · armour, trucks	none
K 104 nm N Anapa · Kuznetsov, 2 corvettes	SA-N-9, SA-15
L 36 nm NE Krasnodar · train	none
M 187 nm W Anapa · cruiser Moskva group	SA-N-6, SA-N-9
N / O Anapa trucks / Kutaisi boats	none

- **The kneeboard card under-reports three:** E and G are listed "soft x5" - they are an SA-10 and an SA-2 site. M is blank - it is the Moskva's group.

OVERLORD ACTUAL

Ask for an area, close out the run · Command 282.000 AM · Overlord is a second voice on Command's frequency.

THE EXCHANGE — "Command, Raider 1, ..."

ASK	permission to proceed to Alpha -> stand by for Overlord
~10 S	Overlord: you are Irene for Alpha, report copy
COPY	copy Irene -> Command: what is there, threat, bearing
OFF	off target -> copy off Alpha, say intentions
HOME	Winchester, RTB -> handoff at 30 nm

ALSO — Command replies

request Alpha / request to work Alpha	**goes to Overlord**
proceeding / pushing / inbound Alpha	**brief at once, no Overlord**
negative Irene	**another flight has it - ask again**
Bingo, RTB	**nearest tanker, handoff at 30 nm**
Joker	**copy Joker**

- **"Irene" and "cleared to engage" both mean go.** Overlord uses either. A flight already on your area is called out - call off target when you are done so it frees up.

TEXACO

Texaco 1-1, 2-1 and 3-1 · Black Sea Day / Night · the same calls on all three · pick the nearest

THE FLOW

two baskets each · "Texaco 1 (2 or 3), Raider 1-1"

COMMAND	request tanker -> bearing, range, contact the nearest Texaco
INITIAL	15 mile initial for port observation, intent to refuel
	-> cleared port observation ... How much do you request?
GIVE	request 5.0 (or full) -> cleared for five thousand pounds
TRAIL	1 mile trail for port observation -> continue
OBSERVATION	established port observation -> baskets open
BASKET	moving to starboard basket -> cleared starboard basket
	established starboard basket -> call ready pre-contact
	ready pre-contact -> cleared contact starboard basket
DCS MENU	Ready pre-contact -> cleared contact, plug, take fuel
REFORM	satisfied, moving to starboard reform -> cleared
CHECK OUT	checking out / moving on to mission -> cleared to depart

RULES

- **Observation is always port, reform always starboard.** Lead makes the initial, trail, observation and check-out calls; each jet its own basket and reform calls.
- **One jet per basket.** A held basket gets "standby, basket occupied" - it frees when that jet calls reform, or after 10 minutes.
- **Fuel won't flow?** SkyEye is radio only - DCS still needs the AI menu Ready pre-contact.

THE TANKERS

Hornet presets

TEXACO 1-1 - KC-130 · TACAN 51Y	**252.100 AM · COMM 2 CH 8**
angels 13, about 260 KIAS	
TEXACO 2-1 - KC-135 MPRS · TACAN 52Y	**252.200 AM · COMM 2 CH 9**
angels 24, about 265 KIAS	
TEXACO 3-1 - KC-135 MPRS · TACAN 53Y	**252.300 AM · COMM 2 CH 10**
angels 24, about 265 KIAS	

Radio check any time - loud and clear. Angels and velocity come live off Tacview.

SHELL

Shell 1-1 and Shell 2-1 · Black Sea Day / Night · KC-135 boom · the same calls on both · pick the nearer one

THE FLOW

one boom, one jet · "Shell 1 (or 2), Venom 1-1"

COMMAND	request tanker -> bearing, range, contact the nearest Shell
INITIAL	15 mile initial for port observation, intent to refuel
	-> cleared port observation ... How much do you request?
GIVE	request 5.0 (or full) -> cleared for five thousand pounds
TRAIL	1 mile trail for port observation -> continue
OBSERVATION	established port observation -> boom open
BOOM	moving to the boom -> cleared to the boom
	established pre-contact -> call ready pre-contact
	ready pre-contact -> cleared contact
DCS MENU	Ready pre-contact -> cleared contact, boom on, take fuel
REFORM	satisfied, moving to starboard reform -> cleared
CHECK OUT	checking out / moving on to mission -> cleared to depart

RULES

- **Observation is always port, reform always starboard.** Lead makes the initial, trail, observation and check-out calls; each jet its own boom and reform calls.
- **One jet on the boom.** The next gets "standby, boom occupied" and holds port observation - the boom frees when that jet calls reform, or after 10 minutes.
- **Fuel won't flow?** SkyEye is radio only - DCS still needs the AI menu Ready pre-contact.

THE TANKERS

Viper presets

SHELL 1-1 - KC-135 · TACAN 61Y	**253.100 AM · COMM 1 CH 7**
SHELL 2-1 - KC-135 · TACAN 62Y	**253.200 AM · COMM 1 CH 8**
both angels 22, Mach 0.68 (about 288 KIAS)	

Radio check any time - loud and clear. Angels and velocity come live off Tacview.

DARKSTAR

GCI · Darkstar 264.000 AM Black Sea · Overlord 266.000 AM Syria · SkyEye's AWACS controller, our voice. Picture, threats, bogey dope.

THE FREQUENCIES

Hornet · Viper preset

DARKSTAR - Black Sea Day / Night, Kola	**264.000 AM · CH 5 · CH 4**
OVERLORD - Syria (Foothold)	**266.000 AM · CH 7 · CH 5**

Foothold: CH 5 Hornet / CH 4 Viper is 264, the DCS AI E-3 - not SkyEye.

THE FLOW

"Darkstar, Raider 302, ..."

COMMAND	checking in on 282 · Command still runs your recovery
CHECK IN	checking in -> radar contact
FENCE IN	fence in -> copy fence in, picture follows
FLY	picture · bogey dope · declare · splash - card 20
FENCE OUT	fence out -> copy fence out
CHECK OUT	checking out -> copy, good day. Then Command: RTB

TO BE HEARD

and to get threat calls

- **Your name must carry your callsign.** DCS name "Raider 302 | Name" or "Venom 212 | Name" - the GCI finds Raider / Venom and the number anywhere in it. SRS name the same as DCS, or threat and merged calls never reach you.
- **Lead with "Darkstar", "Overlord" or "Anyface", then your callsign.** Bearings as three digits ("zero six five"), ranges and altitudes as numbers. No "niner".
- **Command still copies fence in** and adds "Darkstar is up on two six four point zero for picture" - the fence check goes to the GCI, the picture follows.

Overlord Actual on Command (cards 15 - 16) is the range officer, not the GCI.

GCI CALLS

Every call the GCI answers · as Raider 302 hears them · Bullseye and BRAA numbers are examples.

YOU SAY

YOU SAY	Darkstar replies
radio check / comm check	good copy · 5 by 5
checking in	radar contact
fence in / fence out	copy · picture follows fence in
alpha check	contact, alpha check bullseye 010/48
picture	up to 3 groups, from bullseye
bogey dope	group BRAA 045/32, 25000, hot, hostile
any fast movers / any slow movers	bogey dope: jets / helicopters
declare bullseye 010 for 48 at 25000	hostile, friendly, furball, clean
snaplock 125 for 10 at 8000	threat BRAA 125/10, 8000, hot
spiked 080 / strobe 080	spike range 35 ... · clean 080
vector to tanker	bearing and range
splash one / splash	copy splash one
checking out	copy, good day

UNASKED

only if you are on the GCI frequency

every 5 minutes	PICTURE
a hostile inside 25 nm · repeats every 3 min	THREAT
inside 3 nm of a hostile (fixed wing)	MERGED
a hostile off scope 30 s / the GCI comes up	FADED / SUNRISE
no AWACS airborne / back up	OFF / ON STATION

- **It sees what the mission's AWACS sees:** E-3 about 217 nm, E-2 about 200 nm, nothing below its radar horizon or behind a ridge - low in a valley you are hidden. Off station: picture and bogey dope get "off station, no picture".

COMBAT CALLS

Shots, kills, ejections, battle damage · on the AWACS or Command · No station name needed - just your number first.

SHOTS AND KILLS

the AWACS copies · Command copies too

302, Fox 3, 080 for 56, 25,000	**Raider 302, Darkstar, copy Fox three**
302, splash one	**Raider 302, Darkstar, copy splash one**
splash one (no callsign)	**Darkstar, copy splash one**

DOWN

you, your wingman, or anyone who sees it

302 ejecting / eject, eject / bailing out	**Raider 302 down, launching CSAR.**
Raider 301, 302 is down	**Raider 302 down, launching CSAR.**

"302 down to angels 5" is not a down call. CSAR is the radio call only - nothing spawns.

HIT OR DAMAGED

the nearest friendly field

Command, Raider 302, I'm hit	**nearest field, bearing, miles**
mayday / pan pan / declaring an emergency	**elevation, tower frequency**
engine fire / lost an engine / hydraulic failure	**same answer**
fuel leak / battle damage / request nearest field	**same answer**

- **Example:** "Raider 302, Command, copy. Nearest field Kobuleti, bearing zero-eight-three, 18 miles, elevation 59. Kobuleti tower two six two point zero, declare your emergency."
- **Bearing is magnetic, from where Tacview has you.** Not on the scope: "No radar contact, say position, and the nearest field."
- **Foothold never sends you to a red-held field.** Read from the campaign save. None friendly: "No friendly field available, say intentions."
- **Then call that tower with your emergency.** It gives you the runway you name and copies souls and fuel - card 28.
- **Any AWACS name works.** Darkstar, Overlord, Magic or Wizard - the SkyEye AWACS on your frequency answers.

A FULL SORTIE

Off the boat and back · every SkyEye call, in order · Hornet, Case I, Persian Gulf frequencies.

OUTBOUND

DECKBOSS 128.6	request taxi · ready cat N · airborne
MARSHAL 306.3	clear seven miles
COMMAND 282.0	checking in · fence in · on station
GCI 264 / 266	Black Sea / Syria: check in · fence in · picture

ON THE JOB

COMMAND 282.0	state · request tanker · say bullseye
COMMAND 282.0	off station · fence out · RTB
COMMAND 282.0	Inside 30 nm: contact Marshal, call marking mom.

RECOVERY

MARSHAL 306.3	marking moms · DME reports · see you at ten
MARSHAL 306.3	state · established angels N · Charlie
MARSHAL 306.3	commencing · Case I initial / Case III platform
PADDLES 128.3	Black Sea + Syria: ball call, fly his calls (card 10).

- **Syria and Black Sea:** the same frequencies - Marshal 306.300 on COMM 1 CH 3.
- **Vipers:** only the Command calls apply here. Towers are cards 23 - 29.

AIRFIELD ATC

One AI tower per field · UHF AM · Gulf, Black Sea, Syria · Same calls at every field; only name and frequency change.

HOW TO BE HEARD — every tower call

- **Open with the field name, then your callsign.** "Minhad Tower, Raider 1, request taxi". "Tower" can be dropped when the field name comes first: "Akrotiri, Raider 1, ...".
- **No field name, no answer.** "Raider 1, request taxi" is ignored. A bare "Tower, Raider 1, ..." does work.
- **Misheard names are forgiven.** A letter or two off still counts. Mafraq also answers to King Hussein, and H4 to H-4.
- **CTAF style works too:** "Senaki traffic, Raider 1, rolling runway 09".

WHAT THE TOWER KNOWS

- **Runway, wind and altimeter come from the mission weather.** Listen to ATIS first - it gives the same runway.
- **It sees you only through Tacview.** Radar check, traffic holds, go-around and speed calls need the rig's Tacview feed.
- **IMC changes the pattern.** Ceiling under 1,500 ft or visibility under 3 nm: no overhead, straight-in only.

THE TOWER CALLS YOU — no request needed

Over 350 kt inside 10 nm	**speed check**
Inside 5 nm while a jet is rolling	**go around**
Wind shift changes the runway	**runway in use is now NN**
Held short, and the traffic has cleared	**cleared for takeoff**

Built but switched off: "say intentions" and "report clear of the runway".

TOWER RADIOS

Gulf and Black Sea · tower, ATIS, COMM 1 preset · Presets read off the squadron Hornet and Viper cards.

PERSIAN GULF	Hornet / Viper
AL DHAFRA TOWER 251.100 · ATIS 248.200	CH 8 / CH 12
AL MINHAD TOWER 250.100 · ATIS 248.300	CH 10 / CH 14
AL AIN TOWER 250.700 · ATIS 248.850	CH 16 / CH 19

BLACK SEA	Hornet / Viper
BATUMI TOWER 260.000 · ATIS 230.000	CH 8 / CH 12
KOBULETI TOWER 262.000 · ATIS 232.000	CH 10 / CH 14
KUTAISI TOWER 263.000 · ATIS 233.000	CH 12 / CH 18
SENAKI TOWER 261.000 · ATIS 234.000	CH 14 / CH 16
TBILISI TOWER 267.000 · ATIS 237.000	CH 18 / CH 10

THE 7-MILE HANDOFF NAMES A CHANNEL — check it

- **Towers send you to Command on 282.000 and add a channel.** Gulf towers say "channel four"; Black Sea towers say "channel one".
- **That channel is only right for one jet.** Gulf: Viper Command is CH 1, not 4. Black Sea: Hornet Command is CH 4 - Hornet CH 1 is Deckboss.
- **Trust the frequency.** 282.000 is right in every theatre.
- **ATIS is one channel above its tower on every card,** except Viper Gulf CH 20: printed 119.850, but SkyEye's Al Ain ATIS is 248.850.

SYRIA TOWERS

Eastern Med · Foothold · 5 fields · tower and ATIS · Read from the start scripts - dial the frequency.

THE TOWERS

tower · ATIS

AKROTIRI TOWER	252.000	ATIS 249.500
BASSEL AL-ASSAD TOWER	250.600	ATIS 249.600
BEIRUT TOWER	250.650	ATIS 249.700
INCIRLIK TOWER	360.100	ATIS 360.200
RAMAT DAVID TOWER	251.300	ATIS 256.150

KNOW BEFORE YOU FLY

Syria

- **Check the frequency, not only the channel.** The Foothold preset cards number the channels per airframe.
- **ATIS speaks English, then a local language** (Akrotiri English only).
- **The DCS F-menu tower is somewhere else.** Except at Incirlik, DCS's own controller is not on SkyEye's frequency.
- **The 7-mile handoff says "channel four"** - Hornet Command, 282.000.

DEPARTURE

Parking to Command · every SkyEye field · Wait for each reply before the next call.

THE DEPARTURE — in order

REQUEST TAXI	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, request taxi.
	Reply: taxi to runway NN, altimeter, hold short.
HOLDING SHORT	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, holding short.
	Reply: line up and wait.
+ 5 s	Reply: wind, runway, cleared for takeoff.
AIRBORNE	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, airborne.
	Reply: angels N, expect handoff at seven DME.
7 MILES	The tower calls you - you say nothing.
	Tower: leaving my airspace, contact command.
COMMAND	Command, Raider 1, checking in.

IF YOU ARE HELD

- **Traffic inside 20 nm holds you.** Inside 15 nm: "hold short, traffic on N mile final". 15 - 20 nm: line up and wait, no takeoff clearance.
- **60 s between departures.** Too soon after the last jet: "hold short, departure spacing N seconds".
- **Stay put - the tower calls you.** When the traffic or the spacing clears you get your takeoff clearance.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **"ready for takeoff" skips line up and wait:** with no traffic you are cleared at once.
- **"rolling runway NN" (CTAF), "departing" or "clear the active"** after takeoff gets the same reply as airborne.
- **No 7 DME call needed.** The tower calls you at 7 miles (Tacview). Call it anyway and the reply is "copy".
- **Optional:** "pushing command" gets a short good day; "request startup" gets Ground's startup approval.

ARRIVAL

Overhead or straight in · one call per leg · Give your distance with inbound, initial or final.

THE OVERHEAD — VMC

INBOUND	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, 10 mile initial.
	Reply: runway, wind, altimeter, report initial.
INITIAL	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, 3 mile initial.
	Reply: left break runway NN, number N, report base.
DOWNWIND	Optional. Reply: number N, report base.
BASE	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, base, gear down.
	Number one: cleared to land. Otherwise: affirmative.
FINAL	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, on final.
	Reply: runway, wind, cleared to land.
VACATED	Minhad Tower, Raider 1, clear of the active.

- **Past 15 nm you hear "continue inbound, report N miles".** Answer "15 miles inbound" or "15 mile initial".
- **Say "gear down" in your base or final call,** or the tower adds "check wheels down".
- **"initial" or "break" on its own is taken as your break** (reply: report downwind). Give the distance: "3 mile initial".
- **"touch and go", "low approach" or "the option"** in the final call gets that clearance instead.

DISTANCES

- **"15 miles inbound" and "15 mile initial" both work.** So does a bare "15 miles". "7 miles" on its own is the 7 DME departure call.
- **A DME needs "inbound" or "initial".** "12 DME inbound" works; "12 DME" on its own is a departure call.
- **"5 mile final" is a landing call,** the same as "on final".

STRAIGHT IN, IMC, HUNG ORDNANCE

- **"request straight in", "ILS" or "visual approach":** straight-in runway NN approved, altimeter, report final.
- **IMC: the overhead is refused.** Inbound, initial and break get "straight-in only, report ten mile final". Then call "ten mile final".
- **"hung ordnance":** straight in, no overflight, stop at the end of the runway for dearm.

TOWER CALLS

Every call a tower answers · lead with the field name · Silent calls are heard but get no reply.

GROUND AND DEPARTURE

	tower replies
request taxi / ready to taxi	**taxi, hold short**
holding short / at the hold / holding	**line up and wait**
ready for takeoff / request takeoff	**cleared for takeoff**
airborne / departing / rolling	**angels, expect handoff**
(at 7 miles the tower calls you)	**contact Command**
seven DME / seven miles / request handoff	**copy, or contact Command**
pushing command	**good day**

ARRIVAL AND LANDING

N mile initial / N miles inbound	**field information**
3 mile initial / overhead	**break approved**
downwind	**number N, report base**
base / on final / N mile final	**cleared to land**
request straight in / ILS	**straight-in approved**
touch and go / low approach / the option	**cleared touch and go**
going around	**report downwind**
runway vacated / clear of the active	**taxi to parking**

ANY TIME

say again	**your last call, 2 min**
wind check / say altimeter	**wind and altimeter**
radar check	**angels, range, bearing**
radio check / checking in / green jet	**loud and clear**
hung ordnance	**straight in, dearm**
mayday / pan pan / emergency (+ runway NN)	**runway is yours - the one you name**
N souls on board, fuel state	**crash crew standing by**
tally / no joy / altitude check / roger	**silent**

Anything else gets "say again your request".

MULTI-SHIP

Flights of 2 - 6 · one clearance for the whole flight · The lead talks. Name the wingmen on the first call.

DEPARTURE — the lead calls

HOLDING SHORT	Senaki Tower, Raider 301, flight of three,
	302 and 303, holding short.
	Reply: Raider 301 flight, flight of three, line up, wait.
TAKEOFF	Raider 301 flight, cleared for takeoff - all three jets.
AIRBORNE	Senaki Tower, Raider 301 flight, airborne.
7 MILES	Departure calls the flight once.

ARRIVAL

INBOUND	Senaki Tower, Raider 301, flight of two, 302,
	10 miles east, inbound full stop.
	Reply: Raider 301 flight, flight of two, report initial.
BASE / FINAL	Raider 301 flight, cleared to land - both jets.
VACATED	Senaki Tower, Raider 301 flight, clear of the active.
	Ground: Raider 301 spot 12, Raider 302 spot 13.

GOOD TO KNOW

- **Say the size:** "flight of two", "two-ship" or "three FA-18s". Wingmen right after the lead: "302 and 303", "Raider 302, Raider 303" or "1-2 and 1-3".
- **A wingman may call too:** named, or flying within 2 nm of the lead, he is answered as the flight.
- **"Raider 301, flight of two, full stop"** on its own is the landing call: cleared to land for both.
- **Spacing and parking:** the next departure waits 60 s plus 20 s per extra jet. Every jet gets a spot; unnamed wingmen get "spots 12, 13 and 14".

NO ANSWER?

Work down the list · most misses are the first three · Tell the operator what you said, word for word.

CHECK — in order

1	Waited 2 - 3 seconds?
2	Led with the role or field name - Marshal, Minhad Tower?
3	Said your full callsign?
4	Used a trigger word from the calls cards?
5	Half-second pause after keying - call not clipped?
6	Frequency? Marshal 306.3, Paddles 128.3, Hitman 61FM.
	Texaco 252.1/2/3, Shell 253.1/2. GCI: Darkstar 264.0, Overlord 266.0.
7	SRS shows your TX light? Radio AM (Hitman FM), encryption off?

KNOWN QUIRKS

- **Your callsign may be misheard.** Raider as reader or radar, Venom as vino. SkyEye corrects most; if not, slow down and say the digits one at a time.
- **The same call can get a different reply.** Each answer has two to four versions picked at random - the meaning is the same.
- **Marshal needs the number in your callsign.** "Marshal, Raider 1, ..." - a call with no number gets no answer.
- **Paddles answers only the ball call and a radio check.** Everything else he says is his own call on your pass - no readback.
- **The GCI needs your callsign in your name.** DCS and SRS name "Raider 302 | Name" - no Raider / Venom number, no threat calls.
- **Deckboss uses the DCS AI carrier frequency.** You may hear the AI carrier controller on 128.600 as well.

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